11. 近期改变的计划

P2

Question

Describe a plan that you had to change recently You should say: When this happened What made you change the plan What the new plan was And how you felt about the change

Answer

Band score: 6.0–6.5

I'm going to describe a plan I had to change recently. Two months ago, my friend Xiang and I decided to go on a thirty-day trip during the summer holiday, and we made a detailed plan. We were going to visit Beijing and Shanghai**, which** are famous cities in China. Our plan included visiting some famous sites, places of interest, and well-known shops. Both of us were interested in the culture and history of Beijing as well as the beautiful modern views of Shanghai.

However, I was sad to hear some news last week. Xiang told me that he would be attending a summer camp this summer holiday. He had to prepare for many things and study, so he would not have enough time to travel. Then we had to change our travel plan.

After a long period of consideration, we made our final decision. We decided to travel to Beijing only for one week, so that we could still visit the places we had been looking forward to. I was upset at first, but finally I am so happy because I'm glad that Xiang has an opportunity to improve himself.

Problems:

- The answer covers all four bullet points, so the task response is complete.
- Tense inconsistency: "**I am so happy**" should be in the past because you are describing a past situation.
- Some expressions sound unnatural:
  - "**beautiful modern views of Shanghai**" → "modern cityscape of Shanghai"
  - "**prepare for many things and study**" → "prepare for the summer camp and focus on his studies"
  - "**travel to Beijing only for one week**" → "spend only one week in Beijing"
- The story is clear, but the emotional part is not developed enough. IELTS examiners like to hear more about your feelings and thoughts.
- The answer relies heavily on simple sentence structures. More complex structures would help push it toward Band 7.

Polished

I'd like to talk about a plan that I had to change recently.

About two months ago, my childhood friend Xiang and I planned to take a twenty-day trip during the summer holiday. We spent quite a lot of time discussing the plan and making detailed arrangements. Originally, we intended to visit both Beijing and Shanghai because we were interested in **Beijing's rich history and culture** as well as **Shanghai's modern cityscape**.

However, our plan changed unexpectedly about a week ago. Xiang informed me that he had been accepted into a summer camp that would take place during the holiday. Since he needed to **prepare for the program and focus on his studies**, he no longer had enough time to join **a month-long** trip.

After discussing several alternatives, we decided to adjust our plan rather than cancel it completely. Instead of visiting two cities for a whole month, we chose to **spend one week in Beijing only**. This allowed us to visit some of the places we had been looking forward to, such as historical sites and famous attractions.

At first, I was quite disappointed because we had spent a lot of time planning the original trip. However, after thinking about it, I became much more positive. I was happy for Xiang because the summer camp was a valuable opportunity for him to **learn new skills and improve himself**. In the end, I felt satisfied with the new arrangement because we could still travel together, even though the trip was shorter than we had originally planned.

P3

Q1

Do people often change their plans?

A1

Band score: 6.0

Yes, people often have to change their plans when there are some **unexpected situations**. It is **difficult** for people to make a perfect plan because things are always changing. Some **unexpected events** will disturb the original schedule **, so** people have to change their plans to fit the new **situation**. For example, I always change my study plan during the day because of some **unexpected** homework or deadlines.

- "accidents" is not natural here; "unexpected situations/events" is better.
- "without any exception" is unnecessary and unnatural.
- "fit the new trend" is inaccurate; "adapt to the new situation" is more natural.
- The answer is clear but could sound more personal and fluent.

Polished

Yes, I think so. It is quite common for people to change their plans because **unexpected situations often come up**. No matter how carefully a plan is made, things do not always go as expected.

For example, I often adjust my study schedule because of **last-minute assignments or urgent deadlines**. In my opinion, being flexible is important because it helps people **adapt to changing circumstances more effectively**.

Q2

Would you tell others if you change your plan?

A2

Band score: 6.0

No, I don't. I always share my plans after finishing them. I sometimes have to change my plans because **of** some unexpected **events**, and I don't want to tell others about **an uncertain** plan. For example, I only share my plans and results if I succeed in finishing my **work- or study-related plans**.

- "because some unexpected accidents" → "because of some unexpected events".
- "a indeterminate plan" → "an uncertain plan".
- The answer is understandable but sounds slightly unnatural.
- IELTS examiners prefer more direct personal explanations.

Polished

Usually, no. I prefer to tell other people about my plans **after I have completed them**. The main reason is that my plans often change, so I do not want to discuss something that is still uncertain.

For example, when I set a study goal, I usually wait until I achieve it before sharing it with my friends. That way, I can focus on the process instead of talking about it too early.

Q3

Why do you think parents still make plans for their children nowadays?

Q3

Band score: 6.0

I think it is a good idea. Children are too young to make a good plan, so they can do a better job with their parents' guidance. Making a detailed plan can help children to **perform better** during the **process**. Parents are **experienced** and knowledgeable, so they can give more useful information and necessary advice. For example, my father often **teaches** me how to keep **a balance** between life and study, and **he also helps** me make plans.

- "execute well during the progress" is unnatural.
- "informative" is the wrong adjective; use "experienced".
- Subject-verb agreement: "father teaches".
- Good example, but could be expanded slightly.

Polished

Yes, I think many parents make plans for their children because young children often **lack the experience needed to organize their time effectively**.

Parents can provide guidance and help their children develop good habits. For example, when I was younger, my father often helped me create study schedules and taught me how to **balance my schoolwork and personal life**. I think this kind of guidance can be very beneficial for children.

Q4

How does technology help people make plans?

A4

Band score: 5.5

People can get more useful information and tips from **the Internet**, as many people share their experiences on social media platforms. What's more, there are some apps that help people to **carry out** their plans step by step, such as **calendar and note-taking apps**. For example, I often follow the guidance of **Apple Calendar**.

- Capitalization: "People", "Internet", "Apple Calendar".
- "execute plans" is less natural than "carry out plans".
- Repetition: "the guidance of the guidance".
- The answer needs a little more development.

Polished

Technology makes planning much easier. First, people can search for information online and learn from the experiences of others. This helps them make more realistic and effective plans.

In addition, many digital tools, such as calendar apps and reminder apps, help people organize their schedules and keep track of important tasks. For example, I often use **Apple Calendar** to manage my study schedule and remind myself of upcoming deadlines.

Q5

What kind of plans do people often make?

A5

Band score: 6.0

People often make **plans** for their work and trips. Most **people** have to deal with their work efficiently, so they can do a better job with the help of **good planning**. What's more, a good plan can help people to do a better job as well. Because people may **not** be familiar with other cities or countries, they can make a plan for their trip to help them during **their travels**.

- Grammar: "make plan" → "make plans".
- Grammar: "Most of people" → "Most people".
- Repetition of "do a better job".
- Could include one more common type of plan.

Polished

People usually make plans for **work, study, and travel**. For work or study, planning helps people manage their time efficiently and complete tasks on schedule.

Travel plans are also very common because people often need to arrange transportation, accommodation, and sightseeing activities in advance. Without a clear plan, a trip can become stressful and disorganized.

Q6

Do you think people like the process of making plans more, or the moment of carrying them out?

A6

Band score: 6.0

I think people prefer carrying out their plans. It is more challenging and interesting to **execute** a plan because they can encounter some **unexpected events or surprises**. For example, I always find valuable and useful tricks for my research when I am conducting experiments.

- "execute" is correct but "carry out" sounds more natural.
- "unexpected accidents or surprise" → "unexpected events or surprises".
- Good personal example.
- Could explain why people enjoy the process more.

Polished

I think most people enjoy **carrying out their plans** more than making them. Although planning can be exciting, the real experience happens when people put their ideas into action.

For instance, when I conduct research experiments, I often discover **new methods or interesting findings** that I did not expect beforehand. These surprises make the process more engaging and rewarding, which is why I think people generally prefer the implementation stage.

12. 在团队中工作

P2

Question

Describe a time when you worked in a group You should say: What you did Who you worked with What problems you faced And explain why you worked in the group

Answer

> Band score: 6.5

I want to describe a time when I **worked with** my teammates during a programming competition last summer. Our team consisted of four people, including **a coach** and three students. The task was to solve some math problems using programming skills.

Before the competition, we were supposed to communicate with each other to prepare our strategies so that we could cooperate efficiently. Moreover, our coach shared a lot of tips and techniques with us.

During the competition, we encountered many problems because we couldn't immediately find solutions to the math questions. However, we tried our best to find **the answers** and communicated with each other constantly and patiently.

In the end, we solved all the problems and won first prize. It was a memorable experience because it gave me **valuable experience**, and I gained a strong sense of teamwork.

- "cooperated with my teammates" is correct, but **worked with my teammates** sounds more natural in IELTS speaking.
- "including our coach and three students" is slightly awkward because the coach is usually not considered part of the competing team. Better to say "a coach and three students."
- "find solutions to the math questions" is repetitive because "solve problems" and "find solutions" express similar ideas.
- The answer covers all bullet points, but the "why you worked in the group" part is not explained clearly enough.
- The problem faced is quite general. Adding a specific challenge would make the story more convincing.
- The ending is a little generic ("special insights", "sense of teamwork"), which examiners hear very often.

Polished

I'd like to talk about a time when I **worked in a team during a programming competition last summer**.

The team consisted of **three students, including me, and a coach who guided us throughout the preparation process**. Our main task was to solve challenging mathematical problems by writing efficient computer programs **within a limited amount of time**.

Before the competition, we spent several weeks preparing together. We discussed different problem-solving strategies, divided tasks according to our strengths, and practiced previous competition questions. Our coach also shared many useful techniques that helped us improve our efficiency.

During the contest, the biggest challenge was that **some of the problems were much more difficult than we had expected**. At one point, we **got stuck** on a particularly complicated question and couldn't find a solution for quite a while. With the guidance and encouragement of our captian, we exchanged ideas, analyzed the problem from different angles, and gradually **figured out an effective approach**.

In the end, **our hard work paid off**. We successfully solved all the required problems and won **first prize**. I worked in a group because the competition required teamwork, and many problems were **too complex for one person to handle alone**.

It was a memorable experience because it taught me that good communication and collaboration can **make a huge difference** when **facing difficult challenges**. It also **strengthened my teamwork skills** and gave me more confidence in working with others **toward a common goal**.

P3

Q1

Why do some people prefer to work by themselves?

A1

> Band score: 6.0

I think there are several reasons. **Firstly**, some people are not willing to communicate with others because of their personality. **Secondly**, it sometimes costs time and energy to cooperate with others, so maybe working by themselves is a more efficient way. **Thirdly**, some people may enjoy working alone and they can gain more knowledge or skills from that.

- Too many "Firstly/Secondly/Thirdly". This sounds memorized and unnatural in Part 3.
- "working by themselves" → "working on their own" sounds more natural.
- The last point is a bit weak. People usually work alone for independence, concentration, or flexibility rather than gaining more knowledge.
- The answer could be developed with a specific explanation.

Polished

I think there are several reasons why some people prefer to work on their own.

One reason is that they are naturally introverted and do not enjoy constant communication with others. Another reason is that working alone can sometimes be more efficient because they do not need to spend time discussing ideas or coordinating tasks with teammates.

In addition, some people simply enjoy having complete control over their work. They can make decisions independently and work at their own pace, which can be both productive and satisfying.

Q2

What should a leader do to make team members want to follow him or her?

A2

> Band score: 6.5

I believe a leader plays an important role in a team. Firstly, a leader should manage the team members and work to ensure they cooperate with each other efficiently. Secondly, a leader is supposed to get on well with

their team members and avoid conflict and fighting within the team. Team members always need encouragement and praise, so leaders should encourage them and keep them positive and energetic.

- Good structure and relevant ideas.
- "avoid conflict and fighting" sounds slightly childish; "resolve conflicts" is better.
- Too much focus on management. A Band 7 answer usually mentions leadership qualities such as trust, fairness, and communication.
- Again, avoid listing ideas mechanically.

Polished

I think a good leader should be able to **earn the trust and respect of team members**.

First of all, they need strong communication skills so that everyone clearly understands their responsibilities. They should also be fair and willing to listen to different opinions instead of making every decision on their own.

In addition, a good leader should motivate the team and help resolve conflicts when problems arise. When team members feel respected and supported, they are much more likely to follow the leader willingly.

Q3

Should students learn to do group work?

A3

Band score: 6.5

Yes, students can learn a lot from doing group work, and it is an inevitable part of both study and work. Firstly, students can acquire useful skills and gain meaningful insights from their teammates, which helps them improve themselves. Secondly, since group work is often required in many situations, everyone should learn to cooperate efficiently, so that the team can perform well and achieve better results.

- Good response with clear logic.
- "inevitable part" is a good phrase.
- Could sound more natural by giving examples of skills learned.
- "meaningful insights" is a bit formal for speaking.

Polished

Yes, definitely. I think students should learn how to work in groups because teamwork is an essential skill both at school and in the workplace.

When students work together, they can learn from one another and develop important skills such as communication, cooperation, and problem-solving. These skills are difficult to learn from textbooks alone.

Moreover, many jobs require people to work as part of a team, so gaining teamwork experience at school can prepare students for their future careers.

Q4

What group tasks are there in schools?

A4

Band score: 6.5

There are many group tasks in schools, such as group presentations, group projects and brainstorming. All the group members have to leverage their own strengths, and cooperate together to achieve a common goal. For example, I often exchange ideas with my classmates in a brainstorming **session**, and then we are able to come up with **better ideas**.

- "brainstorming" alone is not usually considered a task; "brainstorming sessions" is more natural.
- "cooperate together" is redundant because "cooperate" already means working together.
- "a better idea" → "better ideas" sounds more natural in this context.
- Good example, but the answer could be developed slightly more.

Polished

There are various group tasks in schools, including **group presentations, research projects, classroom discussions, and brainstorming sessions**.

These activities usually require students to work together and contribute according to their strengths. For example, during group presentations, some students may be responsible for collecting information, while others focus on designing slides or delivering the presentation.

I think these tasks are useful because they encourage students to exchange ideas and learn how to collaborate effectively.

Q5

What advantages are there for students experiencing teamwork at school?

A5

Band score: 6.0

I think students can gain a lot when experiencing teamwork. The **most important thing** is that they can learn **valuable knowledge** and useful skills from their teammates, which can help students to improve themselves. What's more, communicating with others efficiently is also a necessary skill for students. For example, I made progress in my studies when I cooperated with my classmates, and **I also did my best** to help them in other **aspects**.

- Grammar: "importantant" → "important".
- "meaningful information" is not a natural collocation; use "valuable knowledge".
- "tried my effort" → "did my best".
- "ascepts" → "aspects".
- The example is relevant but could be explained more clearly.

Polished

I think teamwork offers students several important benefits.

One major advantage is that they can learn from their classmates. Everyone has different strengths and perspectives, so students can gain new knowledge and improve their problem-solving skills through discussion and cooperation.

Another benefit is that teamwork helps students develop communication and interpersonal skills, which are essential in both academic and professional settings. For example, when I worked on group assignments with my classmates, I not only improved my understanding of the subject but also learned how to express my ideas more clearly and listen to others.

Q6

How can you tell if a person is a good leader?

A6

> Band score: 5.5-6.0

To be honest, it is a **difficult** question for me. Some **people** are very good at communicating, while others have a good command **of** managing a team. So I should judge a person from many **aspects**, such as communication skills, management ability, and personality.

For example, in some teamwork **related to studying**, I think a person who **is** knowledgeable is a good leader because **they are** able to **provide** me with necessary information.

- Grammar errors:
  - "diffcult" → "difficult"
  - "persons" → "people"
  - "good command in" → "good command of"
  - "extents" → "aspects"
  - "a person who are" → "a person who is"
  - "person are able" → "person is able" / "they are able"
  - "privide" → "provide"
- The answer focuses too much on knowledge. Knowledge is useful, but leadership is more about guiding and motivating people.
- The structure is slightly unclear and sounds hesitant.

Polished

I think a good leader can be identified by several qualities.

First of all, they should be able to communicate clearly and make good decisions, especially when the team faces challenges. A good leader should also be willing to listen to team members and consider different opinions rather than simply giving orders.

In addition, effective leaders are usually supportive and responsible. They encourage team members when difficulties arise and help the team stay focused on its goals.

For example, when I participate in academic projects, I tend to respect leaders who are not only knowledgeable but also patient and willing to help others. These qualities make people more willing to follow them.

13. 重要决定

P2

Question

Describe an important decision that you made You should say: What the decision was How you made your decision What the results of the decision were And explain why it was important

Answer

> Band score: 5.5-6.0

I would like to describe an important decision that I made recently. Last week, I had a talk with my childhood friend Xiang about famous cities in China. We were both very interested in Beijing because of its rich culture and history. So we decided to go there for a two-week trip.

However, since we are both students, we don't have much time during the term. Therefore, we decided to go to Beijing during the summer vacation. **So that we can enjoy our trip properly.**

We plan to visit some famous sites, including Tiananmen Square, the Great Wall, and the Forbidden City. We will learn a lot about Beijing's culture and history.

This is very important for us because it will allow us to rest after a long period of study. What's more, we can enjoy the local culture, which will **broaden our horizons and open our minds**.

- The biggest issue is that the decision is **not actually completed yet**. The question asks about an important decision you made and **the results of the decision**, but your trip has not happened.
- IELTS examiners generally prefer a decision with a clear outcome rather than a future plan.
- Too many simple "So", "Therefore", "What's more" connectors.
- "So that we can enjoy our trip properly." is a sentence fragment.
- The ending is quite generic ("broaden our horizons and open our minds"), which many candidates use.
- The answer spends too much time introducing the trip and not enough time explaining **how you made the decision** and **why it was important**.

Polished

I'd like to talk about an important decision I made recently, which was **deciding to visit Beijing with my childhood friend Xiang during the upcoming summer vacation**.

The idea came up when we were discussing some of the most famous cities in China. Both of us have always been interested in Beijing because of its long history and cultural significance. After comparing several destinations, we eventually agreed that Beijing would be the best choice.

We made the decision by considering a few factors. Since we are both university students, we are usually quite busy during the semester. As a result, we decided that the summer vacation would be the most suitable time for a longer trip. We also discussed our budget, travel plans, and the places we wanted to visit before making the final decision.

Although the trip has not taken place yet, the decision has already given us something exciting to look forward to. We have started researching attractions such as the Great Wall, the Forbidden City, and Tiananmen Square, and planning the details together has been enjoyable.

I think this decision is important because it gives us an opportunity to **take a break from our studies**, spend time together, and experience a city that **we have wanted to visit for a long time**. It is also a chance to learn more about Chinese history and culture through first-hand experience rather than simply reading about it in books.

- Better addresses **how you made the decision**.
- Acknowledges that the trip **hasn't happened yet**, avoiding a logical gap.
- Gives a more specific explanation of **why it is important**.
- Replaces the cliché "broaden our horizons and open our minds" with more concrete benefits.

P3

Q1

Do you think children sometimes have to make important decisions?

A1

Band score: 6.5

Yes, when children face difficulties **without their parents' company** , they have to make decisions on their own. Moreover, when it comes to important matters, they are expected to **come up with a decision and then solve the problem independently**. Therefore, they often have to make important decisions in many situations by themselves. However, making such decisions can significantly improve their personal skills and help them become **better**.

- "without their parents' company" → unnatural expression, better: "without their parents around"
- "come up with a decision" → better: "make a decision"
- "help them become better" → vague, better: "help them become more independent and mature"
- Some repetition of "decision" and "independently"

Polished

Yes, I think so. Sometimes children have to make important decisions when their parents are not around. For example, they may need to solve problems at school or deal with unexpected situations by themselves. Although this can be challenging, making decisions on their own helps them become **more independent, responsible, and confident**. As a result, it is an important part of their personal growth.

Q2

What important decisions do teenagers need to make after graduation?

A2

Teenagers need to make many decisions after graduation. **Firstly**, they have to decide on their personal goals so that they can manage their time and energy to achieve them. **Secondly**, they have to decide whether to study or work. For example, going to college can help them improve themselves, while working in a company can make them **wealthier**. So, they have to face a lot of important decisions. They are supposed to make these decisions independently without the guidance of their parents or teachers.

- Too many "Firstly/Secondly"
- "improve themselves" is vague
- "make them wealthier" sounds unnatural
- Last sentence is too absolute; many teenagers still receive guidance

Polished

After graduation, teenagers usually face several important decisions. One of the biggest choices is whether to continue their education or start working. If they go to university, they can gain more knowledge and qualifications, while entering the workforce allows them to gain practical experience and earn money earlier. They also need to think about their future goals and career plans, so this period is often full of important decisions.

Q3

Who can children turn to for help when making a decision?

A3

When making an important decision, children can turn to their teachers, parents, friends, or other relatives for help. **Firstly**, parents play the most important role in a child's growth, because they are always willing to offer support without hesitation. **Secondly**, teachers can also provide useful information and meaningful

advice when children are making decisions. **Thirdly**, relatives and friends will share their ideas if children communicate with them and ask for help.

- Again, overuse of Firstly/Secondly/Thirdly
- Sounds slightly memorized
- Could explain the different roles of each person more naturally

Polished

Children can seek help from a variety of people when making decisions. Parents are usually the first people they turn to because they know their children well and genuinely care about them. Teachers can also provide useful advice, especially on academic matters. In addition, friends and relatives may offer different perspectives, which can help children make more balanced decisions.

Q4

Do you think advertisements can influence our decisions when shopping?

A4

Yes, I do. I think advertisements play an important role in our decisions. Sometimes we buy products that are famous and popular because we have seen them on social media platforms. What's more, goods endorsed in advertisements may be cheap or cost-effective, so we tend to buy them. For example, I often buy snacks from TikTok, which is **a famous. Social media platform** with many advertisements.

- Grammar mistake: "a famous. Social media platform"
- "cheap or cost-effective" is not necessarily because of advertising
- Better explain how advertisements influence people psychologically

Polished

Yes, definitely. Advertisements can have a strong influence on our shopping decisions. When we repeatedly see a product on social media, TV, or online platforms, we tend to become more familiar with it and may develop an interest in buying it. Advertisements also highlight a product's features and benefits, which can persuade consumers to choose it over other options. For example, I have bought snacks that I first saw being promoted on TikTok.

Q5

Do you think the influence of advertising is good?

A5

Yes, I do. Advertising helps products reach a wider audience and allows people to better understand their functions, enabling them to make informed purchasing decisions. For example, I once learned about the details of a product on TV and decided to buy it.

- Good answer but slightly short
- Could mention both positive and negative aspects to sound more thoughtful

Polished

Overall, I think advertising has a positive influence. It helps consumers learn about new products and understand their features before making a purchase. As a result, people can compare different options more

easily and make better decisions. However, some advertisements may exaggerate the advantages of a product, so consumers should still think carefully before buying something.

Q6

How do people usually make important decisions?

A6

People often gather useful information and seek advice from friends and relatives when making important decisions. Their support can help us make better choices. Nowadays, **More and more** people share valuable insights on social media, which allows us to access this information easily.

- "More" should not be capitalized
- "Their support can help us" → pronoun inconsistency (people → us)
- Could be expanded with a clearer decision-making process

Polished

People usually collect information before making an important decision. They often discuss the issue with family members, friends, or colleagues to get different opinions. In addition, many people search online for relevant information and experiences shared by others. After weighing the advantages and disadvantages of each option, they choose the one that best suits their needs and goals.

14. 喜欢现场体育赛事

P2

Question

Describe a live sports event you watched and liked You should say: What it was When and where you watched it Who you watched it with And explain why you liked it

Answer

Answer

Band score: 6.5

I would like to describe a kayaking match, **which was a live sports event that I watched and enjoyed very much**. It was a competition held **last vacation**. There were many athletes racing on the river, and we watched the race from the riverbank. I watched it with my teammate Xiang. We are both members of our school's kayaking team, so we love the sport very much. Because we are amateur kayakers and big fans of the sport, watching the live event made us very excited and interested. What impressed me most was that my favorite athlete won the competition and **took first prize**. Additionally, we were able to learn some kayaking skills during the competition, which were meaningful because they helped us improve. I really liked it because I am very interested in kayaking, and I want to improve by watching these professional events.

- **"which was a live sports event that I watched and enjoyed very much"** → redundant and unnatural; "a kayaking competition I watched live" is more natural.
- **"last vacation"** → better: "during my summer vacation last year".
- Too many simple sentences beginning with "I".
- **"made us very excited and interested"** → better: "was incredibly exciting for us".
- **"took first prize"** → better: "won the competition".

- **"which were meaningful because they helped us improve"** → slightly awkward; better explain what skills you learned.
- The ending repeats the idea of liking kayaking and improving; it needs a stronger conclusion.
- The answer responds well to all bullet points but lacks vivid details and emotional description, which limits it to around Band 6.5.

Polished

I'd like to talk about a **live kayaking competition** that I watched during **my summer vacation last year**.

The event took place on a river near my city, and spectators gathered along the riverbank to watch the race. I went there with my teammate Xiang, who is also a member of our school's kayaking team. Since we both enjoy the sport, we were really looking forward to the competition.

The race itself was extremely exciting. Several professional athletes competed against one another, and the atmosphere was energetic because the audience kept cheering throughout the event. What impressed me most was seeing **my favorite athlete win the race after a very close competition**. It was exciting to watch such a high level of performance in person.

Another reason I enjoyed the event was that I learned a lot by observing the athletes' techniques. For example, I paid attention to their paddling rhythm and how they maintained their balance while moving at high speed. These were things that I could apply to my own training later.

Overall, **it was a memorable experience because it combined entertainment with learning**. Watching professional athletes compete not only made me enjoy the sport even more, but also motivated me to work harder and improve my own kayaking skills.

P3

Q1

Why do some people like to watch sports events?

A1

Some people are big fans of live sports events, and enjoy watching them. For example, I enjoy watching kayaking **games** because I always kayak in my spare time. What's more, watching exciting events can provide a sense of thrill and satisfaction. Many people feel excited when they see sports matches.

- **"kayaking games"** → better: "kayaking competitions" or "kayaking races"
- "provide a sense of thrill and satisfaction" is acceptable but slightly repetitive
- Could develop the answer further by mentioning entertainment, teamwork, or admiration for athletes
- The example is relevant and natural

Polished

Some people enjoy watching sports events because they are entertaining and exciting. They can experience strong emotions while supporting their favorite teams or athletes. For example, I enjoy watching kayaking competitions because I take part in the sport myself. In addition, watching professional athletes perform at a high level can be both inspiring and enjoyable.

Q2

Where do people normally watch sports events?

A2

Some people enjoy watching sports events on TV at home, while others prefer watching them in the stadium. For example, I enjoy watching NBA games on TV because I can stay at home and enjoy some snacks.

- Good answer, but slightly short
- Could explain the advantages of both options
- "NBA games" is natural and appropriate

Polished

People usually watch sports events either at home or in sports venues. Many people prefer watching them on TV because it is convenient and comfortable. However, some fans enjoy going to stadiums because they can experience the exciting atmosphere and cheer for their favorite teams in person. Personally, I prefer watching NBA games at home while relaxing with some snacks.

Q3

What are the advantages of watching sports events online?

A3

Watching sports events online can provide a sense of closeness. What's more, it can feel as if we are enjoying the event in person. For example, I prefer watching live NBA games on TV, and I really enjoy them.

- "provide a sense of closeness" is vague
- The answer is too short and does not fully discuss the advantages
- Watching online is not necessarily the same as watching on TV

Polished

Watching sports events online has several advantages. First, it is very convenient because people can watch matches anywhere using their phones or computers. Second, online platforms often provide live comments, highlights, and instant replays, which make the viewing experience more enjoyable. In addition, it is usually much cheaper than attending the event in person.

Q4

What sports matches are suitable for children to attend?

A4

There are many sports suitable for children. They can play popular and interesting games like basketball or football. What's more, children can also try some sports that provide competitive and special experiences, such as horse riding or kayaking. For example, when I was young, I used to enjoy playing basketball with my childhood friends.

- The question asks what sports matches children should **attend/watch**, not what sports they should **play**
- Slight misunderstanding of the topic
- Good example but not fully relevant

Polished

I think children can attend a wide variety of sports matches, especially those that are safe and easy to understand. For example, basketball, football, and table tennis matches are usually suitable because they are exciting and family-friendly. By watching these events, children can learn about teamwork, sportsmanship, and healthy competition while having fun at the same time.

Q5

Why do some people spend a lot going to other countries to watch sports events?

A5

I think there are several reasons why people enjoy watching sports events in person. They want to experience the atmosphere in the stadium, and they also have the chance to meet famous sports stars when traveling to other countries. For example, my favorite NBA star is **Michael Jordan**, and I hope to see him play in the. United States, which can provide me with a sense of satisfaction and excitement.

- Good main idea
- **"see him play"** is unrealistic because Michael Jordan retired many years ago
- **"in the. United States"** contains a grammar/punctuation mistake
- Could mention tourism and supporting favorite teams

Polished

There are several reasons why some people are willing to spend a lot of money traveling abroad to watch sports events. First, they want to experience the atmosphere of a major competition in person, which is often much more exciting than watching it on TV. Second, they may support a particular team or athlete and want to see them compete live. In addition, many people combine sports events with tourism, making the trip even more worthwhile.

Q6

What sports games are popular in your country?

A6

Many Chinese enjoy playing basketball and table tennis. **As for the young**, they prefer playing basketball and spending time with their friends**., While** table tennis is popular among older citizens because it is less competitive and beneficial to physical health. For example, you can often see people playing table tennis in parks.

- **"As for the young"** → better: "Young people"
- Punctuation error: **"friends., While"**
- "less competitive" may not always be true
- Good use of examples

Polished

In China, basketball and table tennis are among the most popular sports. Young people are particularly interested in basketball because it is exciting and allows them to socialize with their friends. Table tennis is also extremely popular among people of all ages because it is easy to access and does not require much space. For example, it is very common to see people playing table tennis in parks and community centers.

15. 特别场合的食物

P2

Question

Describe a food that people eat on special occasions/events You should say: What it is What the special event/occasion is How it is cooked/made And explain why people eat it on that special occasion/event

Answer

Band score: 6.5

I would like to describe a special food that Chinese people eat on special occasions, which is **mooncakes**. Many Chinese people eat mooncakes during the **Mid-Autumn Festival**, which takes place in the middle of the eighth lunar month. On these special occasions, many people reunite with their families, drink tea, and eat mooncakes together. What's more, the most important thing is to admire the full moon on that day. Mooncakes are **a symbol of the reunion** because of their circular shape. They are made of flour, nuts, and meat. After mixing these ingredients together, they are put into a mold, and then **the making process is finished**. Mooncakes taste delicious and look beautiful. They are a symbol of traditional Chinese culture, so people eat them during the Mid-Autumn Festival not only because of their taste, but also for their special meaning.

- **"a special food that Chinese people eat on special occasions"** → repetition of "special"
- **"a symbol of the reunion"** → better: "a symbol of family reunion"
- **"flour, nuts, and meat"** → too general; many mooncakes have different fillings
- **"the making process is finished"** → unnatural; baking is missing from the process
- The answer covers all bullet points but lacks personal feelings and vivid details
- The cooking process is oversimplified
- The ending is good but could be more engaging and specific

Polished

I'd like to talk about **mooncakes**, which are a traditional Chinese food commonly eaten during the **Mid-Autumn Festival**.

This festival is celebrated on the fifteenth day of the eighth lunar month, when families usually gather together to enjoy a reunion dinner, drink tea, and admire the full moon. Eating mooncakes is one of the most important traditions on this occasion.

Mooncakes are typically made from flour, syrup, and oil, and they are filled with ingredients such as lotus seed paste, red bean paste, nuts, or salted egg yolks. After the filling is wrapped in the dough, the cakes are placed in special molds to create beautiful patterns and then baked until they turn golden brown.

People eat mooncakes during the Mid-Autumn Festival because they **symbolize family reunion and togetherness**. Their round shape resembles the full moon, which represents harmony and completeness in Chinese culture.

Personally, I really enjoy eating mooncakes with my family while appreciating the moon. **It creates a warm and festive atmosphere, and it reminds me of the importance of spending time with loved ones.**

P3

Q1

Why are there special foods on special occasions or events?

A1

Special foods often carry symbolic meanings. For instance, certain traditional Chinese dishes represent **specific memories of occasions**. A good example is that people eat mooncakes during the Mid-Autumn Festival and zongzi during the Dragon Boat Festival.

- **"specific memories of occasions"** → unnatural collocation; better: "are associated with particular festivals and traditions"
- The answer directly addresses the question but is slightly underdeveloped
- Good examples, but the explanation could be deeper

Polished

Special foods often have cultural or symbolic meanings. People eat them on important occasions because they are closely connected with traditions and customs. For example, Chinese people eat mooncakes during the Mid-Autumn Festival because they symbolize family reunion, while zongzi are traditionally eaten during the Dragon Boat Festival. These foods help people remember the significance of the occasion and preserve cultural traditions.

Q2

What are the differences between everyday food and festival food?

A2

Everyday food is **normal and common**, and we eat it in our daily lives. However, we can only eat special foods on certain festivals. For example, traditional Chinese foods like zongzi and mooncakes are served during traditional festivals, while we can eat daily dishes almost every day.

- **"normal and common"** → repetitive
- **"we can only eat special foods on certain festivals"** → not entirely accurate nowadays
- The comparison is clear but lacks detail

Polished

The main difference is that everyday food is eaten regularly, while festival food is linked to special celebrations and traditions. Everyday meals are usually chosen for nutrition and convenience, whereas festival foods often carry cultural significance. For example, people may eat rice, vegetables, and meat every day, but foods like mooncakes and zongzi are especially popular during traditional festivals because they have symbolic meanings.

Q3

Are there any differences between the food people eat today and the food people ate in the past?

A3

Yes, I think the differences between the food people eat today and the food people ate in the past lie in the **types and quality of nutrition**. In the past, people were often poor and couldn't afford expensive food, so they had to rely on cheap, sometimes unhealthy options. However, nowadays we can afford healthier food and have more options, which allows us to live a healthier life.

- **"types and quality of nutrition"** → better: "the variety and nutritional value of food"
- Good comparison between the past and present
- The logic is clear and relevant to the question

Polished

Yes, there are several differences. Nowadays, people have access to a much wider variety of food than previous generations. Thanks to economic development and improvements in transportation, people can easily buy food from different regions and countries. In addition, many people pay more attention to nutrition and healthy eating. In contrast, people in the past often had fewer choices and focused mainly on having enough food to meet their basic needs.

Q4

Do people today prefer eating at home or in a restaurant?

A4

I think it depends on people's lifestyles. Young people tend to prefer eating out, while older citizens often eat at home. Some people enjoy cooking for themselves, which gives them a sense of satisfaction and achievement. However, eating out offers more options, allowing us **to. Choose** whatever we want. For example, I sometimes like eating hamburgers and **fried chips in canteen**, and I feel satisfied with the food, although I know they are not very healthy.

- Grammar error: "**to. Choose**"
- "**fried chips in canteen**" → better: "French fries in the cafeteria"
- Good balance between eating at home and eating out
- Personal example makes the answer more natural

Polished

I think it depends largely on people's lifestyles and preferences. Young people are generally more likely to eat in restaurants because it is convenient and offers a greater variety of food. In contrast, older people often prefer eating at home because home-cooked meals are usually healthier and more economical. Personally, I sometimes eat out with my friends because I enjoy trying different foods, but I also appreciate home-cooked meals because they are often healthier and more comforting.